



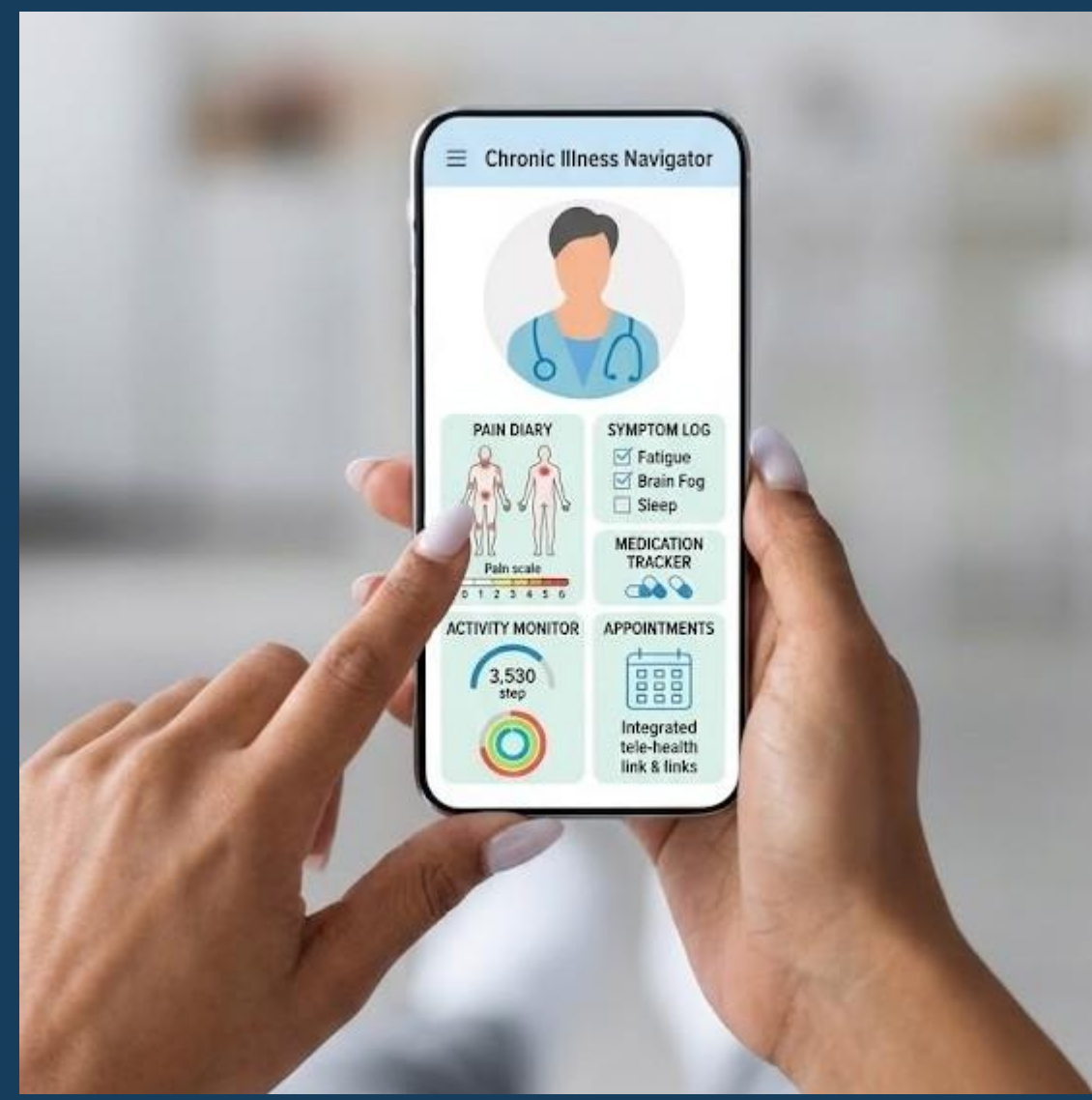
TELE-GERIATRIC
RESEARCH
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Fibromyalgia & Chronic Illness mHealth Apps

Mapping the gap in digital symptom care (a cross-sectional analysis of 168 apps)

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Presenter: Dr. Noon Yousif



218

Apps screened

168

Apps analyzed

16

Fibro-specific

73.8%

On iOS

36.3%

Include AI

Background

- Effective Fibromyalgia management depends on consistent **patient self-tracking and energy pacing**, with fatigue, cognitive impairment & psychological distress.
- Despite many mHealth apps for general symptoms, **few address fibromyalgia directly**.
- This research evaluates the **clinical usefulness, accessibility & interface limitations** of mHealth apps supporting FM patients.

Methods

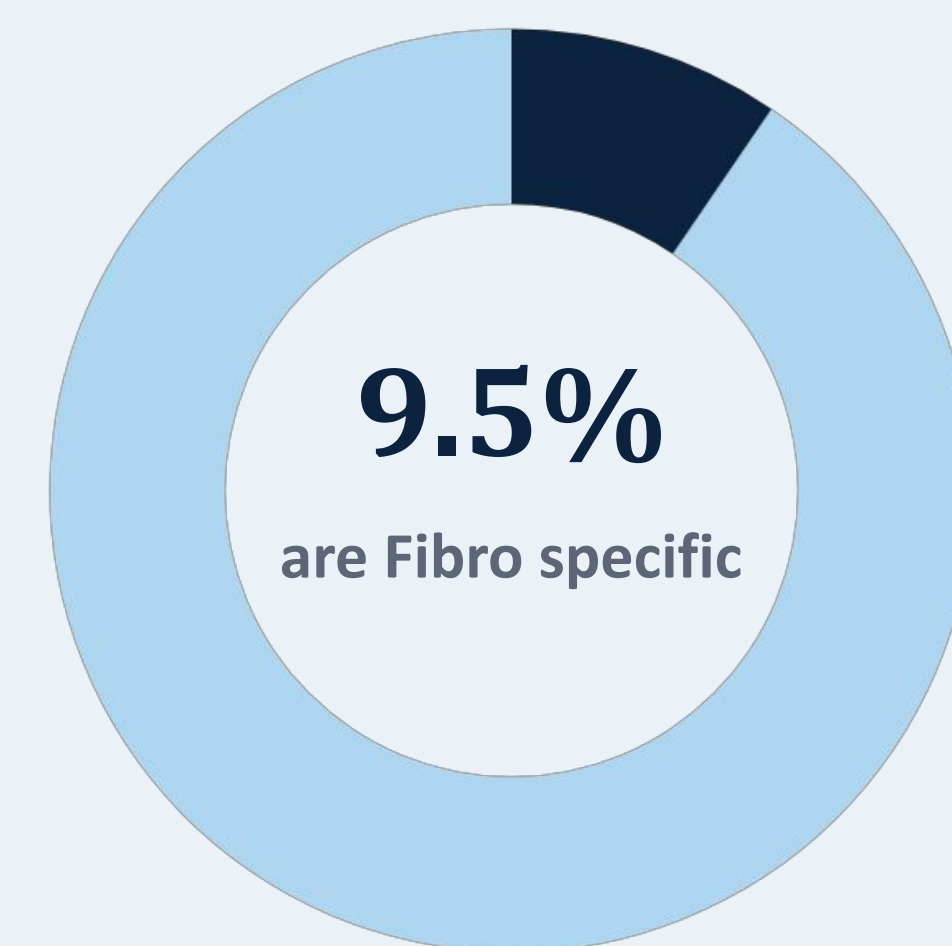
218 Apps identified through search terms

168 Relevant to chronic or fibromyalgia and chronic pain

16 fibromyalgia-specific

- Cross-sectional review of **Apple App Store & Google Play Store**.
- Collected platform data, financial costs & clinical features: BP logging, wearable sync, medication tracking, reminders & AI analytics.
- Qualitative user feedback** analyzed to identify barriers to sustained app use.

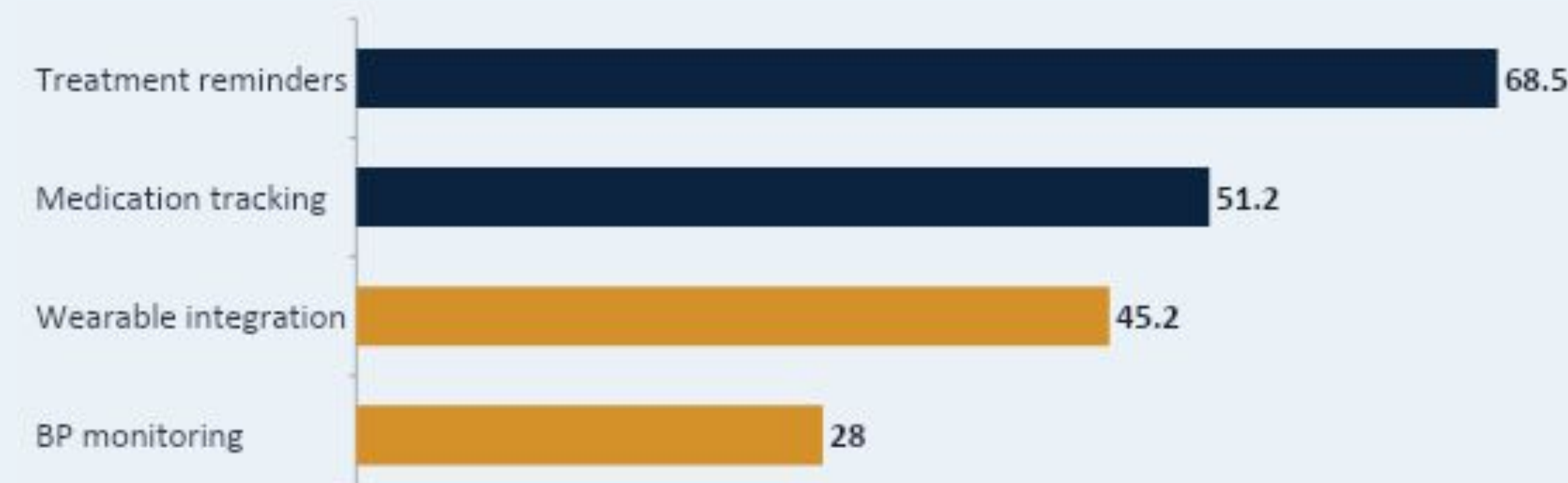
Results



16 fibromyalgia-specific apps
7 on iOS · 9 on Android

152 broader pain, symptom & wellness apps

MOST COMMON FEATURES (% OF APPS)



iOS

4.47 / 5

73.8% · 367,550 reviews



Android

3.80 / 5

26.2% · 13,092 reviews

51.2%

use a **freemium model** :
highest-rated (mean 4.52)

36.3%

include **AI** : mostly
chatbots, not flare
prediction

Results

- Two top apps were **prescription-only or hospital-sponsored**, showing formal clinical access drives engagement.
- Barriers: **fatigue during flare episodes, costly add-on charges & app instability**.

Conclusion & Recommendations

- Only a small proportion of apps are designed specifically for Fibromyalgia patients- current mHealth apps show **significant gaps** in Fibro-specific support.
- Most apps stop at **basic data logging** : journal entries, BP readings, medication lists. Without offering **predictive insights or flare management** that could actually help patients.
- Need for apps with greater emphasis on **wearability to automate data logging** and tracking for **energy management**.
- Premium access models** gate key features behind paywalls, limiting accessibility for patients who need them most.
- Formal channels for patient support : **Clinical access & reimbursement** leads to significantly greater patient engagement.

Why it matters

- Fibromyalgia care depends on **day-to-day symptom tracking & energy pacing**, yet patients rely on generic tools not built for their needs.
- These needs should be addressed with **future digital health tools** designed in partnership with clinicians & patients.
- Developers, clinicians, and patients need to co-design the next generation of Fibromyalgia apps.

